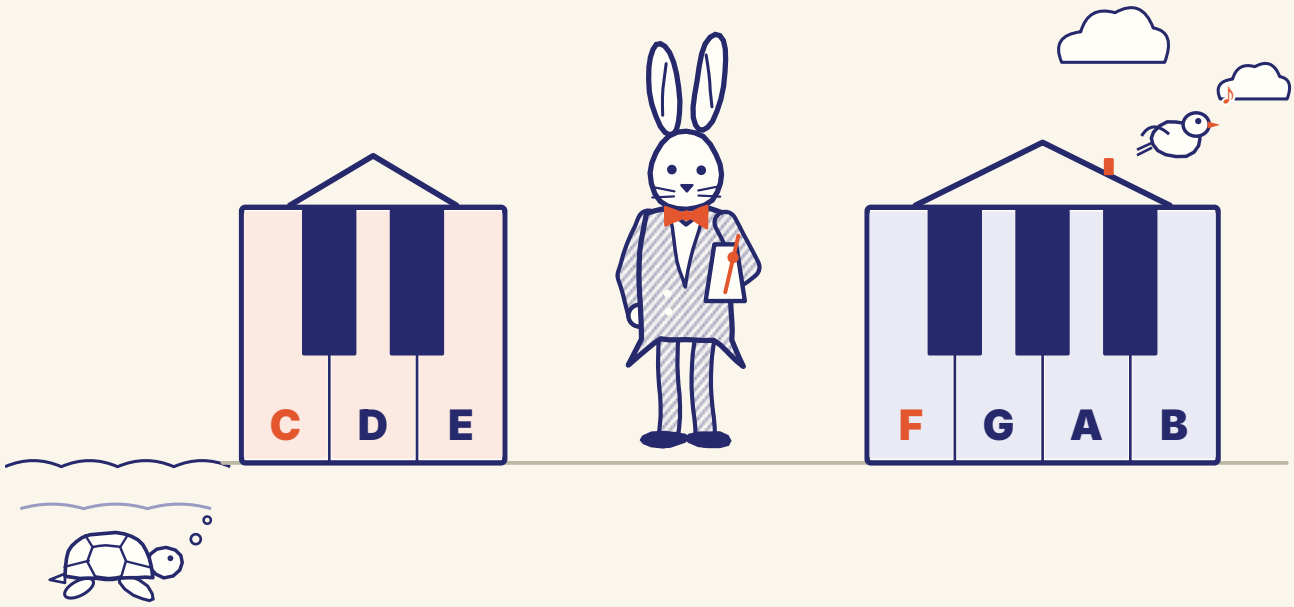
CHAPTER 2

Keyboard Patterns

The piano looks like 88 different keys -- but it is one small pattern, repeated: a small house of 2 black keys that carries 3 white keys, and a big house of 3 black keys that carries 4. Learn the pattern, and every key on the piano tells you its own name.



In this chapter

- [ ] Small house, big house **page 2**
- [ ] The white keys of each house **page 3**
- [ ] The seven letter names **page 4**
- [ ] The whole piano & middle C **page 5**
- [ ] Play on the patterns **page 6**
- [ ] My five checks **page 7**

By the end, you can

- ✔ find any small house or big house
- ✔ say which white keys belong to each house
- ✔ name every white key, C to B
- ✔ find middle C on a real piano
- ✔ play your first tune on the black keys

ONLINE

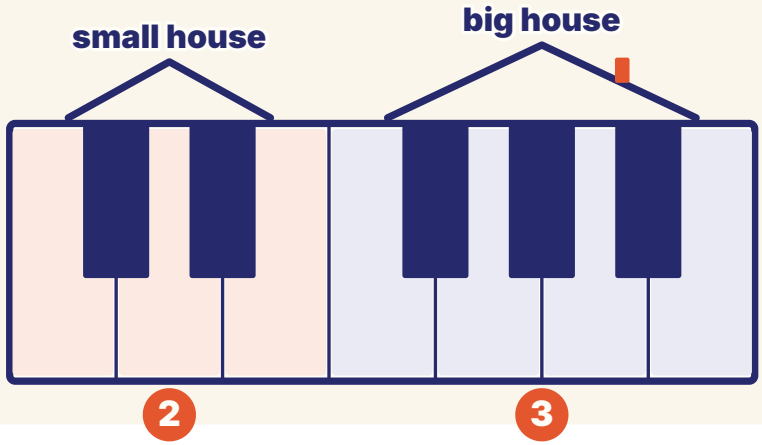
The lesson and the drill. Scan, pick a level, aim for 9 out of 10.

1. High or low? __/10
2. Small house or big house? __/10
3. What's this key's name? __/10

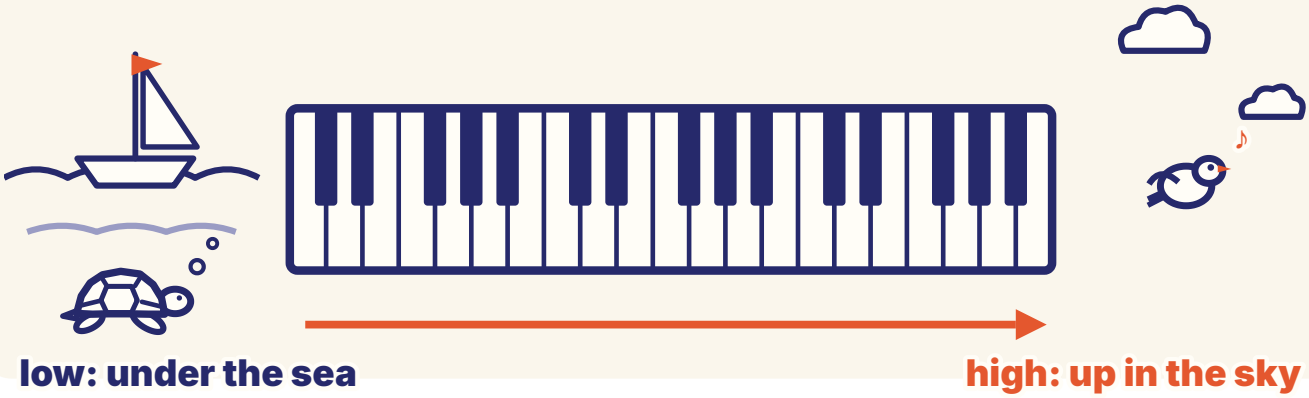
Step 1

Small house, big house

The black keys are the **roofs** of the houses. **Two black keys** = the small house's roof; **three** = the big house's. Small, big, small, big... the same two houses repeat all the way up the piano.



And the street climbs from **left** to **right**: the low sounds live at the left end with **the turtle under the sea**, the high sounds at the right end with **the bird up in the sky**.



At the piano

1. Find a **small house** and a **big house** near the middle of the piano. ☐
2. Travel from the very bottom to the very top, saying it out loud: "small house... big house... small house..." ☐
3. Close your eyes. Someone plays one high or one low sound -- point to the turtle's end or the bird's end. ☐

REMEMBER **A 2-key roof = the small house. A 3-key roof = the big one. Low left, high right.**

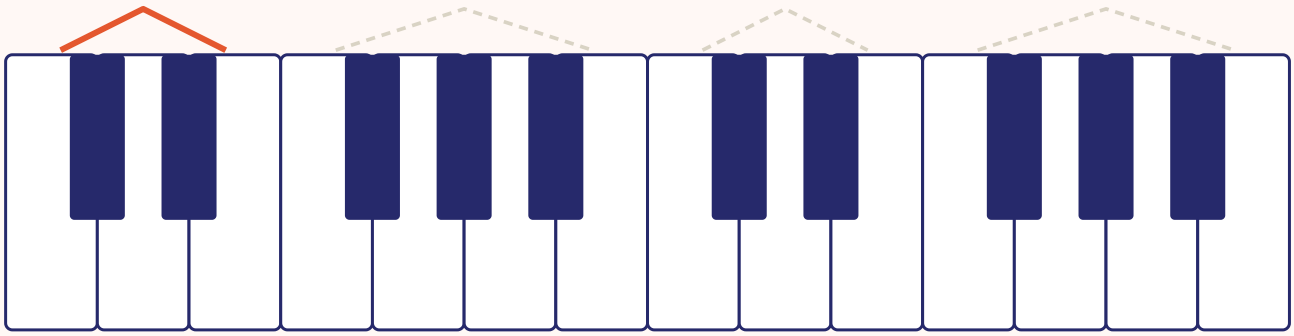
Lesson step 1

online

TRY IT Draw the roofs

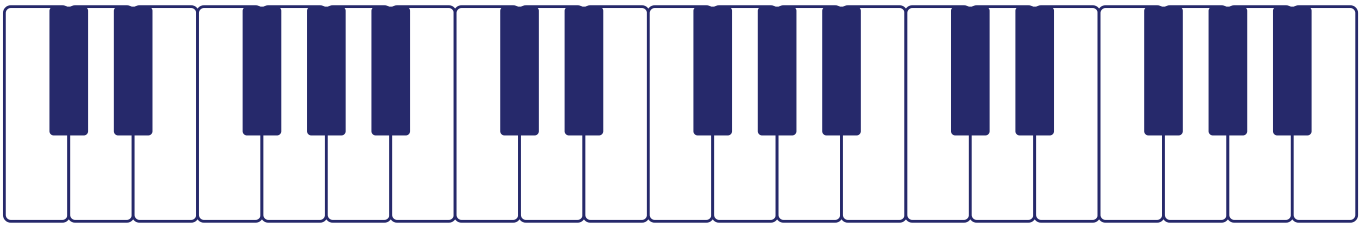
Draw a roof over every group of black keys -- a small roof over 2, a big roof over 3. The first one is done.

EXAMPLE



YOUR TURN Count the roofs

Colour the small roofs' black keys one colour and the big roofs' black keys another. Then count them.



Small houses: ☐ Big houses: ☐

★ PLAY Turtle or bird?

Make each sound with your voice first. In each pair, one is lower and one is higher: draw a line from the lower one to the turtle and from the higher one to the bird -- then find both sounds on the piano!



low



a chick
cheep cheep!



a cow
moooo



a lion
ROAR



a mouse
squeak!



a whistle
tweeeet!



a ship's horn
booooo



high

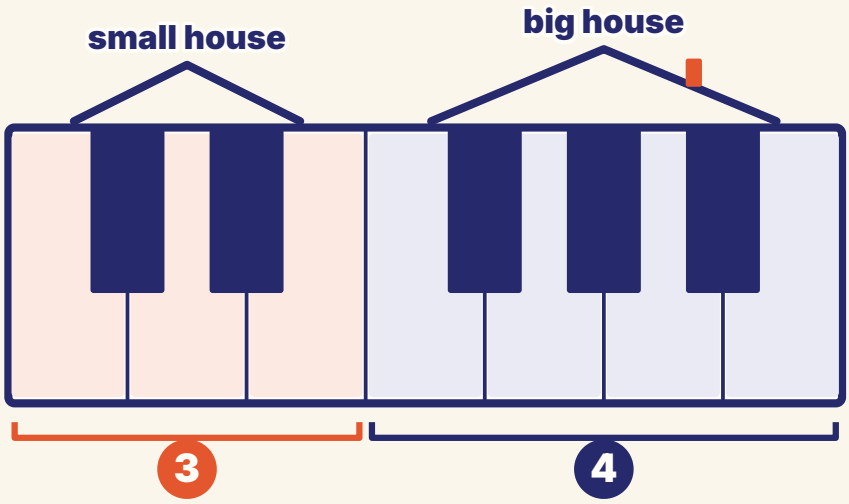
Listen to your own voice: a deep **moooo** sits **low** · a squeaky **cheep** sits **high**

How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ Checked ☐

Step 2

The white keys of each house

A white key is never just anywhere -- each one lives **under a roof**. Under the small roof live **3** white keys (left door, inside, right door); under the big roof live **4**. The faint colours in the picture show who belongs to which house. 3 + 4 = **7** -- after seven, the street starts again.



At the piano

1. Find a small house and play its **3** white keys in turn: left door, inside, right door. ☐
2. Move to the big house next door and play its **4** white keys in turn. ☐
3. Travel up the whole piano saying "three... four... three... four..." ☐

REMEMBER **Every white key lives under a roof: 3 under the small one, 4 under the big.**

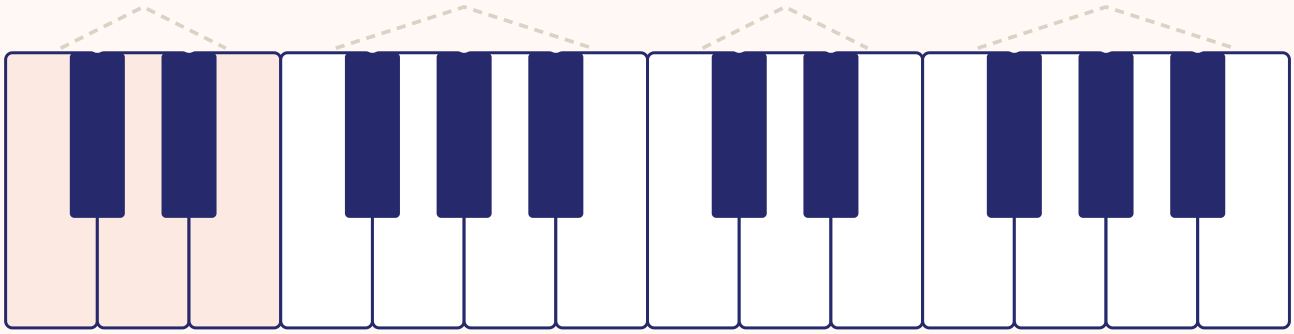
Lesson step 2

online

TRY IT Who lives under each roof?

Colour the 3 white keys under every small roof one colour and the 4 under every big roof another. The first house is done.

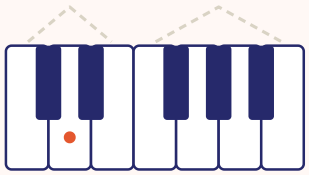
EXAMPLE



YOUR TURN Whose house?

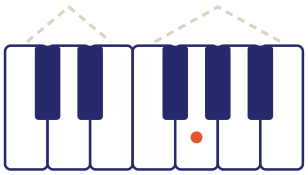
Is the dotted white key under a small roof or a big roof? Write S or B.

EXAMPLE

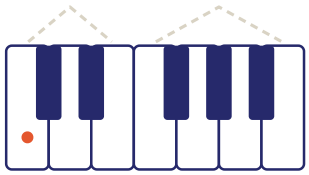


S

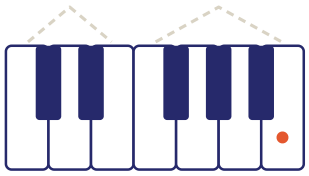
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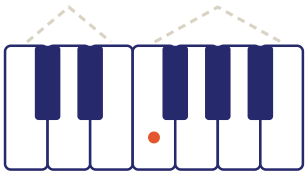
3



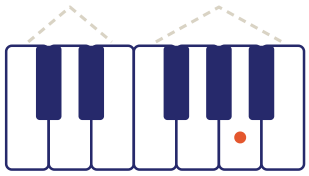
4



5



6



★ PLAY Who lives here?

Draw a family of 3 under the small roof and a family of 4 under the big one -- one for each white key. Give them names!



Small house: 3 live here



Big house: 4 live here

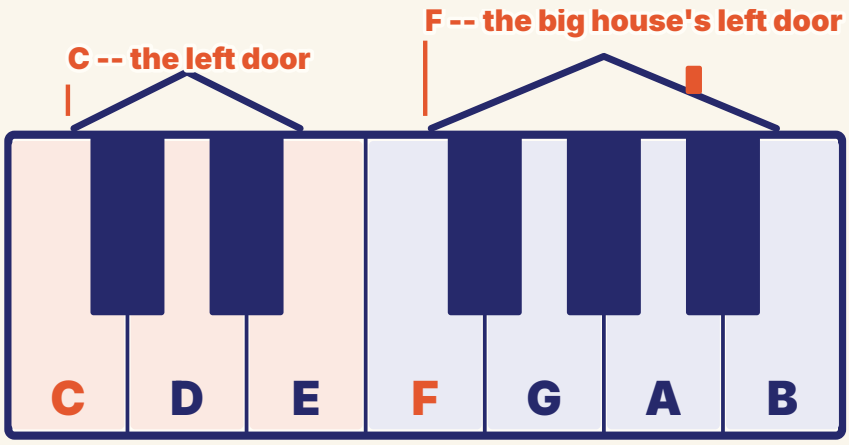
How did it feel? Circle one.

Checked

Step 3

The seven letter names

Music uses just **seven letters**: **C D E** live at the small house and **F G A B** at the big one. **C is the small house's left door** and **F is the big house's** -- learn the two doors, and you can walk to every other name. After G? A again.



At the piano

1. From the bottom to the top, find and play **every C** -- one at each small house's left door. ☐
2. Now find and play **every F** -- the big house's left door. ☐
3. Someone says a letter (D, G, B...); use the two houses to find that key and play it. ☐

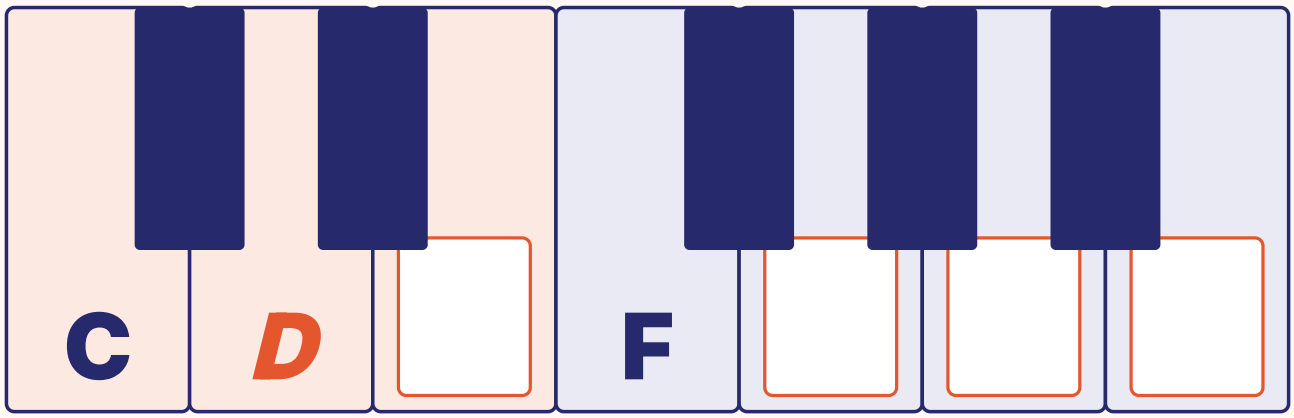
REMEMBER **C D E at the small house, F G A B at the big -- and after G comes A.**

Lesson step 3 online

TRY IT Write the names on the doors

C is the small house's left door, F is the big house's. Write the other five letters. The first one is done.

EXAMPLE



Example: D sits inside the small house, between its two black keys.

YOUR TURN Name the dotted key

Find the two left doors first (C and F), then walk to the dot. Write its letter.

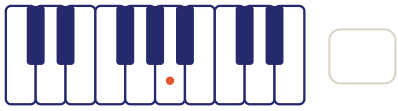
EXAMPLE



2



3



4



5



6



★ PLAY Spell a word on the keys

Music only uses A B C D E F G -- but they make words! Find each word on the piano and play it letter by letter. Then make up your own.

BAG ☐ CAFE ☐ FACE ☐ BEAD ☐ CAGE ☐

BADGE ☐

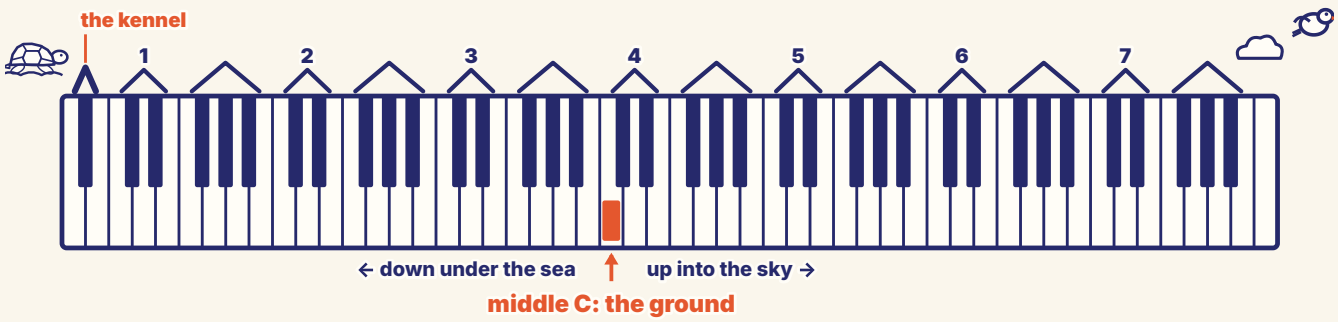
My word: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ Checked ☐

Step 4

The whole piano & middle C

A real piano has **88 keys** -- yet still only 7 small houses and 7 big ones. Count to the **4th small house**: its left door is **middle C**. Middle C is **the ground**: go right and you climb **up into the sky**, higher and higher; go left and you dive **down under the sea**, lower and lower.



At the piano

1. Count the **small houses** from the bottom: 1 up to 7, touching each one. ☐
2. Find the **lonely black key** at the very bottom -- right beside it is the lowest key of all. ☐
3. Play **middle C**; then the C one house lower (down into the sea) and one house higher (up into the sky). ☐

REMEMBER **Middle C is the ground: up into the sky, down under the sea.**

Lesson step 4 online

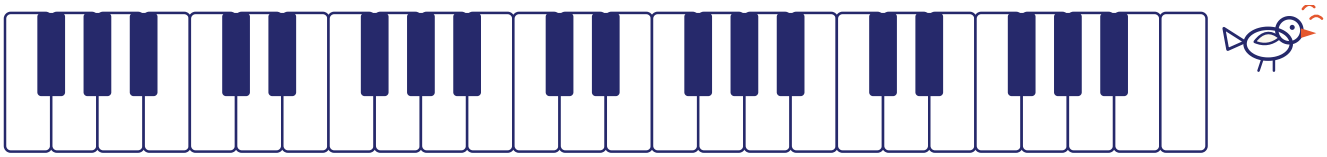
TRY IT Count the houses on a real piano

A real piano has 88 keys. Count the small houses together, from left to right, ticking each one.

Bottom half -- the low keys, the turtle's end under the sea



Top half -- the high keys, the bird's end up in the sky (carry on counting here)



Small houses: 7

YOUR TURN Your turn on the big piano

Use the keyboard above.

1 · Count the big houses: ☐

2 · Draw a little kennel over the lonely black key at the very bottom.

3 · Draw a star on **middle C** -- the white key just left of the 4th small house.

★ PLAY Under the sea, up in the sky

Middle C is the ground. Draw what swims under the sea (to the left of middle C) and what flies up in the sky (to the right of it). Then play their sounds!

Under the sea (low)



middle C: the ground

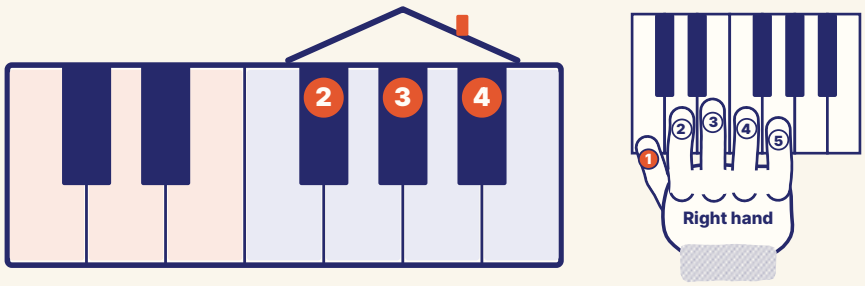
Up in the sky (high)

How did it feel? Circle one.  Checked ☐

Play

Play on the patterns

Now the map pays you back. Your first tunes need no written notes: just the **black-key roofs** and fingers **2, 3, 4** of both hands. Play **smooth as honey** (legato) -- like a relay baton, the old finger lets go the moment the new note sounds.



Hot Cross Buns right hand 2 3 4 on the big roof; one circle = one steady beat

4 3 2 ○ | 4 3 2 ○ | 2 2 2 2 3 3 3 3 | 4 3 2 ○

More tunes in the online lesson — left hand 2 3 on the small roof, right hand 2 3 4 on the big one: **Mary Had a Little Lamb**, **Old MacDonald**, **Rain Rain Go Away**. All famous, all free to use -- play them with their finger numbers in the online lesson.

At the piano

1. Right-hand **2, 3, 4** on a big roof near the middle; sing and play slowly: **4 - 3 - 2...** ☐
2. Play it again one big roof higher -- a higher voice! Then try left-hand **2, 3** on a small roof. ☐
3. **Echo:** someone plays two or three black keys; you play them straight back. Then make up your own tune! ☐

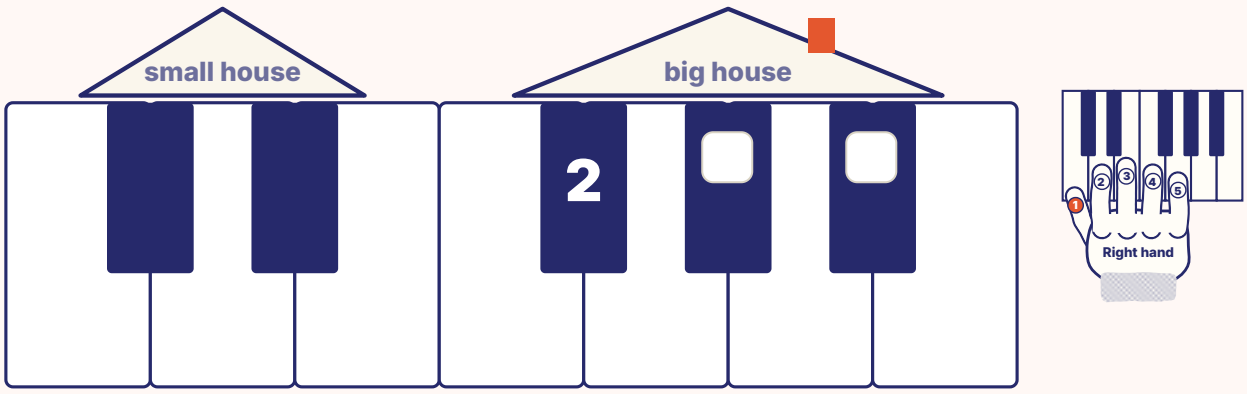
REMEMBER **Legato: a relay baton -- the old finger lets go as the new note sounds.**

Lesson step 5 online

TRY IT Fingers on the roofs

Right hand on the big roof: 2 on the first black key, 3 in the middle, 4 on the highest. Write the finger number on each black key.

EXAMPLE



YOUR TURN Hot Cross Buns

The song in finger numbers. Fill in the missing numbers, then tick each one you do this week.

4	3	2	4		2	2		2	2	3		3	3		3	

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Hot Cross Buns, right hand	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hot Cross Buns, one big roof higher	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Echo game with someone at home	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My own black-key tune	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

★ PLAY The relay baton: legato

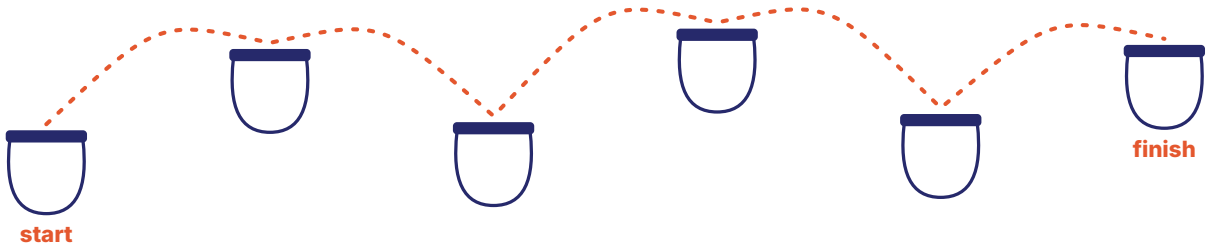
Hold the key until the next one plays -- the moment it sounds, let the old one go. Trace the dotted path from pot to pot in one smooth line -- don't lift your pencil, no gaps: that's legato!



Legato: one foot is always on the ground.



Not legato: a gap between every step.



How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ Checked ☐

Check-up

My five checks

At the piano: show each one and give yourself a star. On paper: do the check-up below. All done? Colour in the badge!

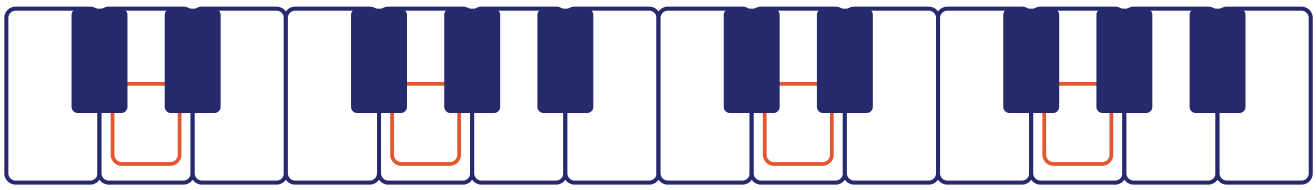
At the piano

		Lesson 1	2	3	4	5	6
	I can find a small house and a big house anywhere	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	I can say each house's white keys: 3 and 4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
C D E F G A B	I can name any white key (C at the small house's left door)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	I can find middle C (just left of the 4th small house)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	I can play Hot Cross Buns legato with 2 3 4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

On paper

Name _____ Date _____ · no help, no piano · about 10 minutes

A Write S under each small house and B under each big house.



B Whose house is the dotted white key? Write S (small) or B (big).

5  ☐

6  ☐

7  ☐

8  ☐

C Name the dotted key. Write its letter.

9  ☐

10  ☐

11  ☐

12  ☐

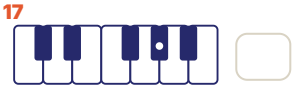
D Middle C: count the small houses from the bottom.

13 Middle C is the left door of small house number ☐ 14 A piano has ☐ keys.

E Hot Cross Buns: which finger plays the dotted key?

15  ☐

16  ☐

17  ☐

18  ☐